

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	The sacramental nature of reality: Catholic teachings about how the whole of creation manifests the presence of God; the meaning and effects of each of the seven sacraments, including Catechism of the Catholic Church 1210–1211; the practice and symbolism of each sacrament; how sacraments communicate the grace of God; divergent Christian attitudes to sacraments, including reference to Orthodox and Protestant Christianity.
3.2*	Liturgical worship within Catholic Christianity: the nature and significance of the Mass for Catholics, including its structure and the Eucharist as the 'source and summit of Christian life', with reference to Lumen Gentium paragraph 7; divergent Christian attitudes towards the practice and meaning of liturgical worship, including its significance for Catholics and the less structured worship in evangelical Christian denominations.
3.3	The funeral rite as a liturgical celebration of the Church: practices associated with the funeral rite in the home, the church and the cemetery, including reference to 'Preparing my funeral' by Vincent Nichols, Archbishop of Westminster; the aims of the funeral rite, including communion with the deceased; the communion of the community and the proclamation of eternal life to the community and its significance for Catholics.
3.4	Prayer as the 'raising of hearts and minds to God': the nature and significance of different types of prayer; the Lord's Prayer, including Matthew 6:5–14, set (formulaic) prayers and informal (extempore) prayer; when each type might be used and why; the importance of prayer and the importance for Catholics of having different types of worship.
3.5	The role and importance of forms of popular piety: the nature and significance of the Rosary, Eucharistic adoration and Stations of the Cross; how each of these might be used and why; the importance of having different types of worship for Catholics, including reference to Catechism of the Catholic Church 1674–1676; divergent Christian attitudes to these forms of piety.
3.6	Pilgrimage: the nature, history and purpose of Catholic pilgrimage; the significance of the places people go on pilgrimage; divergent Christian understandings about whether pilgrimage is important for Christians today, with specific reference to Jerusalem, Lourdes, Rome, Walsingham and the Catechism of the Catholic Church 2691–2696.
3.7	Catholic Social Teaching: how Catholic Social Teaching reflects the teaching to show love of neighbour; Catholic teaching on justice, peace and reconciliation, Evangelii Gaudium paragraphs 182–237 – The inclusion of the poor in society; how these teachings might be reflected in the lives of individual Catholics, including reference to Matthew 25:31–46 (the Parable of the Sheep and Goats); the work of CAFOD, what it does and why.
3.8	Catholic mission and evangelism: the history and significance of mission and evangelism for Catholics; divergent ways this is put into practice by the Church and individual Catholics locally, nationally and globally, and how this fulfils the commission of Jesus and teachings of the Church, including Evangelii Gaudium Chapter 5.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Catholic teachings about the origins and value of the universe: scientific explanations for the origins of the universe and Catholic responses to them, including the work of Georges Lemaître; the value of the universe in Catholic teaching; divergent Christian responses to the possible view that the universe can be used as a commodity, including interpretations of Genesis 1–2.
4.2	Catholic teachings about the sanctity of life: why Catholics regard human life as holy; how the Bible can be interpreted to show life as special, including reference to being created in the image of God as shown in Genesis 1–3; the importance of the sanctity of life for Catholics today.
4.3	Catholic responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins and value of human life, such as evolution and survival of the fittest; Catholic responses with reference to October 27, 2014, Pope Francis’s statement at the Pontifical Academy of Sciences about evolution; the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Catholics today.
4.4	Implications of Catholic teachings about value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: the nature of abortion; Church teachings about abortion, including reference to <i>Humanae Vitae</i> ; divergent pro-life and pro-choice Christian, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Catholic responses to them.
4.5	Catholic teachings and beliefs about life after death: Catholic teachings that support the existence of a life after death, including Ephesians 2:1–10; divergent Christian and non-religious arguments for life after death (including remembered lives, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones); the significance of belief in life after death for Catholics.
4.6	Catholic responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Catholics reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts and social control), including 1 Peter 3:18–22.
4.7	Implications of Catholic teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: the nature of euthanasia; Church teachings about euthanasia, including Catechism of the Catholic Church 2276–2279 and support for hospice care; divergent Christian, non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Catholic responses to them.
4.8	Catholic responses to issues in the natural world: Catholic responses to threats to the world including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources; stewardship and humanity’s role as stewards; differing Catholic responses to animal rights, animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, with reference to Catechism of the Catholic Church 2415–2418, including the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.

Area of Study 1B – Christianity

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Christianity as a lived religion within the United Kingdom and throughout the world, and its beliefs and teachings on life, specifically within families, and with regard to matters of life and death.

There are four sections: Christian Beliefs, Marriage and the Family, Living the Christian Life and Matters of Life and Death.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices to Christians today should be explored throughout the sections. This should include reference to how the Bible informs a Christian's understanding of the topics and how approaches to the issues are underpinned by philosophical arguments and ethical theory as applicable.

Students will be expected to study Christianity within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should recognise that Christianity is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, Judaism, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast two areas of belief and practice within Christianity with one of either Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, Judaism, or Sikhism:

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.6)*
- The practice and significance of worship (3.1)*

Students should compare and contrast the areas of ethics and/or philosophy within Christianity with non-religious views as outlined in the content below.

Students should also recognise that within Christianity there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Christianity in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Catholic, Orthodox, Protestant and other Christian traditions.